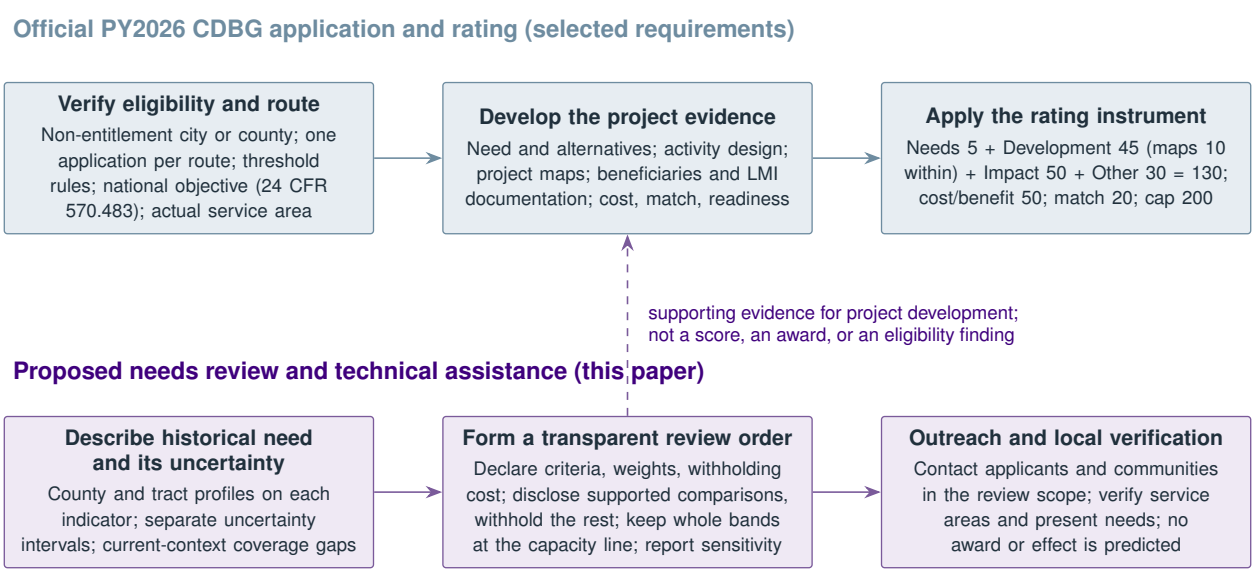
Official PY2026 CDBG application and rating (selected requirements)
Verify eligibility and route
Non-entitlement city or county; one application per route; threshold rules; national objective (24 CFR 570.483); actual service area
Develop the project evidence
Need and alternatives; activity design; project maps; beneficiaries and LMI documentation; cost, match, readiness
Apply the rating instrument
Needs 5 + Development 45 (maps 10 within) + Impact 50 + Other 30 = 130; cost/benefit 50; match 20; cap 200
supporting evidence for project development; not a score, an award, or an eligibility finding
Proposed needs review and technical assistance (this paper)
Describe historical need and its uncertainty
County and tract profiles on each indicator; separate uncertainty intervals; current-context coverage gaps
Form a transparent review order
Declare criteria, weights, withholding cost; disclose supported comparisons, withhold the rest; keep whole bands at the capacity line; report sensitivity
Outreach and local verification
Contact applicants and communities in the review scope; verify service areas and present needs; no award or effect is predicted